

The menstrual cycle

The menstrual cycle is the process that enables a female's body to make a baby. The cycle is counted from the first day of a period to the day before the start of the next period.

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How it works

The female hormones, estrogen and progesterone, regulate the menstrual cycle. As the levels of these hormones rise and fall, the menstrual cycle progresses. Its four stages take 28 days on average, but can last from 21 up to 35 days. The length of each stage may vary.

